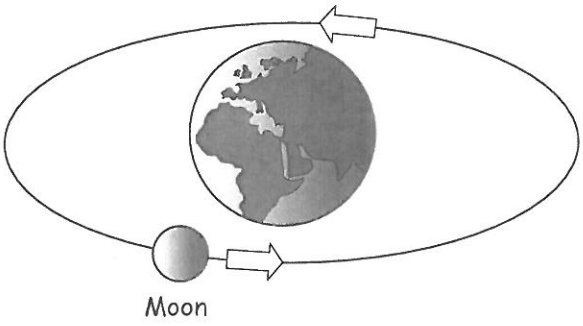
W.S.85. **Satellites.** Name .....

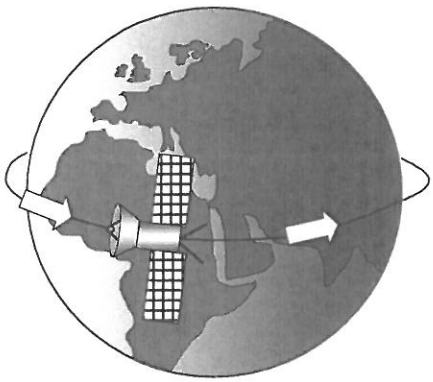
The planets are attracted towards the sun by an invisible force called GRAVITY. This is what keeps the planets in orbit. In the same way the Moon orbits the Earth because of the pull of gravity between them. Any object that travels around a planet in this way is called a SATELLITE. Humans have sent artificial satellites into space. These are very useful in several ways.

The Moon is our natural satellite.



The Moon travels anticlockwise around the Earth. It takes 27.3 days to complete one orbit. During this time the Moon changes from a full moon to nothing and then back to a full moon again. This happens because we only see the part of the Moon which reflects light from the Sun. The part that is in shadow does not show up. We see different amounts of the lit side as the Moon travels around the Earth. Early people used this cycle to keep track of the months.

Artificial satellites.



Artificial satellites have the following uses :

1. To observe and photograph the Earth.
2. To study weather systems.
3. To send radio and TV signals around the world.
4. To look deeper into Space. In Space there is no atmosphere (air) to cloud our view. The Hubble telescope is a satellite that has helped us to discover more about the Universe.

Exercise - Fill in the missing words in the passage below.

The Moon orbits the Earth because of the pull of ..... Any object that orbits the Earth is called a ..... The ..... is the Earth's natural satellite. It takes about twenty seven days for the Moon to complete one ..... During this time the Moon appears to change shape from a ..... moon to nothing and then back again.
If a satellite is given too much ..... it will escape into Space. If it has too little speed the force of gravity will pull it back down to ..... The Hubble ..... is a satellite that helps us to see much more clearly into Space. It can do this because in Space there is no ..... to block our view.

Earth full air speed telescope gravity Moon satellite orbit

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